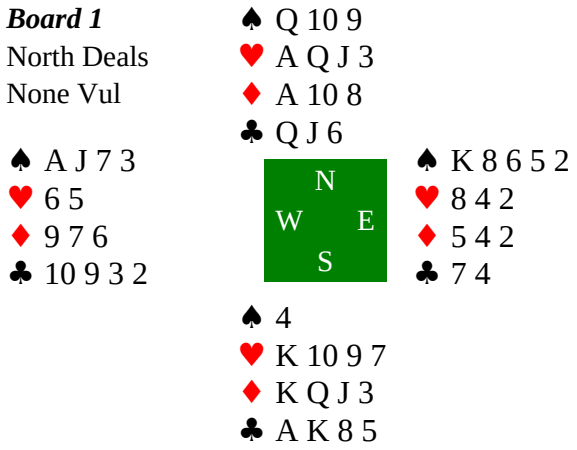
Board 1
North Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣7

North opens 1NT.

You have another big hand. And with a 4-card Major you start with 2♣. Partner answers 2♥ and it's your turn again.

What with your singleton ♠ you certainly have enough points for slam. But since it's possible partner has only one Ace you check with Blackwood. Partner says 5♥ and you say . . . What?

Missing one Ace you bid 6♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 7 3
♥ A 8 2
♦ Q 9 8 4
♣ 5 4 2

♠ A K Q 4 2
♥ J 10 7 6
♦ 7 5
♣ 9 3

♠ 9 5
♥ K Q 9 5
♦ A K 6 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ 10 8 6
♥ 4 3
♦ J 10 2
♣ A J 10 7 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♦J

East opens 1NT.

This may go against your instincts, but if you're going to play Stayman then you should follow the rules. Granted that you have a great ♠ suit, you also have 4 ♥s. And when you have a 4-card Major you use Stayman. You bid 2♣ and partner says 2♥.

That is why you used Stayman - to uncover a 4-4 Major suit fit. Having done so you know that you will play in ♥s and you have enough points to bid game. You bid 4♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 10 8 6 ♥ K Q 5 ♦ A 8 6 4 ♣ A K 10	
♠ J 7 ♥ A 8 4 3 ♦ K Q J 2 ♣ J 4 2		♠ 9 5 3 ♥ 9 2 ♦ 10 9 3 ♣ Q 8 7 6 5
	♠ A K Q 4 2 ♥ J 10 7 6 ♦ 7 5 ♣ 9 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♦K

North opens 1NT.

Yes, this is the same hand as Deal 8. Again you bid 2♣10his time partner says 2♦.

You need to describe your hand clearly to partner with this bid. You want to show a game-forcing hand (11 points or more) with 4 ♥s and 5 ♠s. You do that by now jumping to 3♠.

If partner had just 2 ♠s he would have bid 3NT. Since he has 3 ♠s he bids 4♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ 8 7
♥ 8 7 4
♦ K J 9 2
♣ K 9 6 2

♠ A Q J 9
♥ K J
♦ Q 7 6 4
♣ Q 5 3

♠ K 10 4 2
♥ A Q 10 9 6 3
♦ —
♣ 8 7 4

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 5 2
♦ A 10 8 5 3
♣ A J 10

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥4

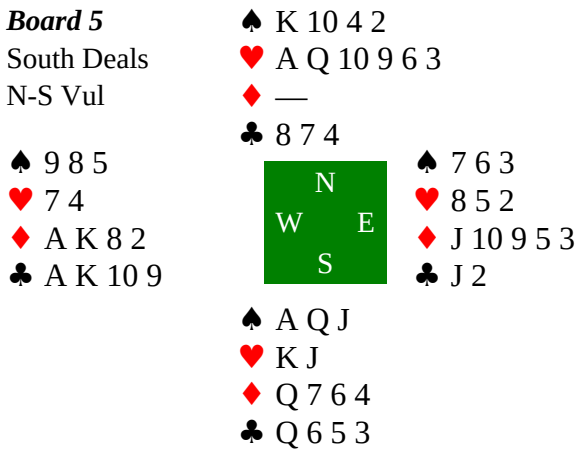
West opens 1NT.

Even when you hold a 6-card Major, if you have 4 cards in the other Major you use Stayman. Partner answers 2♠.

You've found an 8-card Major fit and you know there are enough points for game. So you bid 4♠.

Yes, but you already knew you had an 8-card ♥ fit since partner's 1NT promised at least 2 ♥s. In fact, you could play game in either Major. However, it is often better to play in a 4-4 fit rather than a 5-3 or 6-2. This hand shows why. Played in ♥s you will make exactly 10 tricks with any opening lead. Played in ♠s you will again make 10 tricks when the defenders start with their 3 ♣ winners. If they start with anything else you are very likely to make 1 or 2 overtricks by discarding dummy losers on your ♥ suit.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♣J

This is the follow-up to Deal 10. South opens 1NT.

Just like the previous deal with a 4-card Major you use Stayman. This time partner says 2♦. Your turn again.

With partner showing no 4-card Major the bidding takes a turn. With your 6 ♥s you are sure of an 8-card fit in the suit. With 11 points you must be sure of reaching game. So you bid 4♥.

In this case the strong hand does not become declarer, but the contract is the right one anyway.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A J 9
♥ J 9 8 5
♦ K 10 2
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 8 3
♥ K Q 7 4
♦ 7 6 4 3
♣ A 8 2

♠ K 10 4 2
♥ A 3
♦ Q J 9 5
♣ K Q 7

♠ Q 7 6 5
♥ 10 6 2
♦ A 8
♣ J 10 5 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT			
All Pass			

2NT by East
Lead: ♥6

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♣.

Partner has commanded you to bid a 4-card Major if you have one. You have one, so you bid 2♠. Partner now says 2NT.

Partner evidently has 4 ♥s. He also evidently has about 9 points since he is INVITING you to bid 3NT. With your minimum 15 points you decline the invitation by passing.